

Quem Manda **Aqui?**

Who's in charge here?

Causative & permission verbs: Make, Get, Let and Allow. Five ways to talk about control in English, from force to permission. This booklet collects the lesson, the practice lab, and a reading, in one printable set.

01 Quem Manda Aqui, the main lesson

02 Practice Lab, judgment and transformation

03 Reading Lab, Two Ways to Raise a Kid

04 Answer key

SECTION 01

Quem Manda Aqui

Five case files, one for each structure. Photo, story, collocations, and a note in Portuguese wherever the grammar hides a trap.

WHY THIS LESSON MATTERS

*Tal coisa te deixa louco. Tal pessoa te deixa nervoso. Em português, **deixar** faz dois trabalhos ao mesmo tempo: permissão e causa.*

In English, they're two different verbs. Your instinct will often reach for **LET**, because that's what "deixar" means most of the time. But a feeling someone causes in you is **MAKE**, not LET. "It lets me crazy" doesn't exist. "It makes me crazy" does.

ONE MORE THING BEFORE WE START

Every "someone" and "something" in this lesson is a placeholder. "Someone" is already an object, and in a real sentence you'll almost never say the word "someone" itself, you'll use an object pronoun instead.

I → me	he → him	she → her	it → it	we → us	they → them
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So "make someone happy" becomes, in real life, **make her happy, make him furious, make it worse**. Keep an eye out for this across all five cases.

01

MAKE (OBJECT) + ADJECTIVE

MAKE + OBJECT + ADJECTIVE (or comparative)

Not an action. A feeling or a state that something causes, in a person or in a situation. The adjective can also level up into a comparative: “it makes things worse”, not just “it makes things bad”.

FORCE

PERMISSION

Sunday afternoon at the Miller house. Nobody is really in charge, but everyone in that room is feeling something, and something outside of them is causing it.



1 make her focused

The homework makes her focused, but the drawing makes her happier.

2 make him relaxed

Video games after a long week make him relaxed.

3 make him hungry

Chopping vegetables next to the stove makes him hungry.

4 make her calm

The dog sleeping at her feet makes her calm.

BORROW THESE

make someone **happy**

make someone **nervous**

make someone **proud**

make someone **uncomfortable**

make someone **bored**

make someone **frustrated**

WITH THINGS, AND WITH COMPARATIVES

make it **worse**

make it **better**

make it **harder**

make it **easier**

make things **complicated**

PUSH IT FURTHER: EXTREME ADJECTIVES

tired → **exhausted**

exausto(a)

angry → **furious**

furioso(a)

happy → **thrilled**

radiante, muito animado(a)

interesting → **fascinating**

fascinante

hungry → **starving**

faminto(a), morrendo de fome

scared → **terrified**

apavorado(a)

surprised → **astonished**

pasmo(a), estupefato(a)

bad → **awful**

péssimo(a), horrível

Not “very furious”. **Absolutely furious.**

Real talk. Sem verbo de ação depois do objeto, só adjetivo. E esse objeto não precisa ser gente: “it”, “things”, “the situation” entram no mesmo lugar. O adjetivo também pode virar comparativo, “makes it worse” é tão comum quanto “makes me happy”.

COMPLETE THE ONE THAT FITS YOUR LIFE

Long meetings that go nowhere make me _____

Being stuck in traffic every morning makes me _____

A compliment from my boss makes me _____

Skipping breakfast always makes my whole morning _____

02

MAKE SOMEONE DO

MAKE + person + BASE VERB

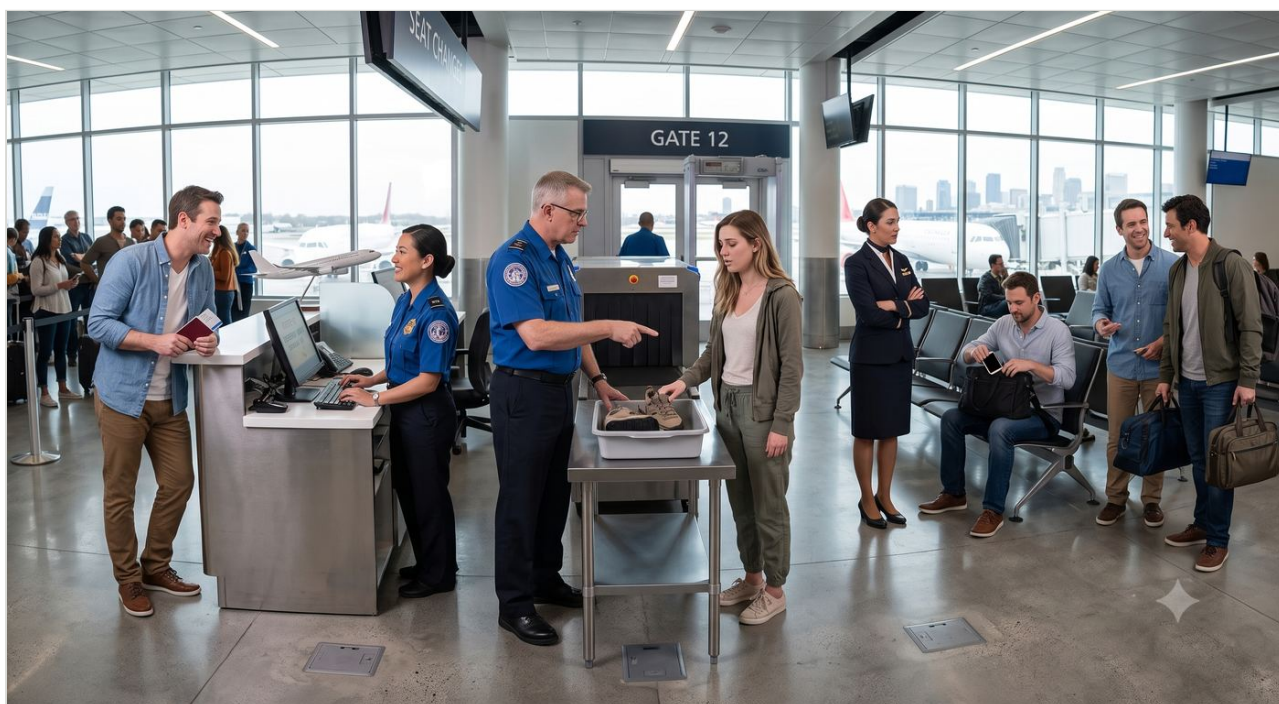
An action, and no choice about it. Someone with authority forces it.



FORCE

PERMISSION

Gate 12. The line moves, the officer points, and nobody argues. This is what obligation looks like when it has a uniform.



1 make her take off her shoes

Security makes every passenger take off their shoes before the scanner.

2 make passengers empty their pockets

The machine makes travelers empty their pockets first.

3 make him show his passport

The agent makes him show his passport before printing the boarding pass.

BORROW THESE

make someone **wait**

make someone **remove**

make someone **sign**

make someone **repeat**

make someone **show ID**

Real talk. Sem “to”: “make her take off”, nunca “make her to take off”. Igual ao LET. O difícil aqui não é a gramática, é lembrar que não tem escolha.

COMPLETE THE ONE THAT FITS YOUR LIFE

My manager always makes me _____

Airport security makes every passenger _____

My landlord makes tenants _____

03

GET SOMEONE TO DO

GET + person + TO + VERB

Persuasion. There is a choice, but you work to influence it.

FORCE

PERMISSION

The customer wasn't planning to spend that much today. Twenty minutes later, he's nodding at the estimate. Nobody forced him. Somebody just explained it well.



1 get him to approve the repair

The mechanic gets him to approve the repair by explaining exactly what's broken.

2 get her to sign the estimate

The receptionist gets her to sign the estimate before the work starts.

3 get him to trust the shop

Years of honest work get customers to trust the shop.

BORROW THESE

get someone to **agree**

get someone to **understand**

get someone to **reconsider**

get someone to **calm down**

get someone to **commit**

Real talk. GET traz o “to” de volta, e muda o sentido: alguém foi convencido, não obrigado. “I got him to do it” soa bem mais diplomático que “I made him do it”.

COMPLETE THE ONE THAT FITS YOUR LIFE

It took me a week, but I finally got my landlord to ___ the leak. _____

She got her coworkers to ___ the new software without complaining. _____

I got the mechanic to ___ me a better price. _____

04

LET SOMEONE DO

LET + person + BASE VERB

Permission, informal. You don't stop it. You simply say yes.

FORCE

PERMISSION

Saturday, the park is full, and for once nobody is in a hurry. Today the answer to almost everything is yes.



1 let her swing higher

Her mother lets her swing higher every time she asks.

2 let them go down the slide

The teacher lets them go down the slide two at a time.

3 let him build a sandcastle

His dad lets him build a sandcastle as tall as he wants.

4 let her buy an ice cream

Her mom finally lets her buy an ice cream from the cart.

BORROW THESE

let someone **choose**

let someone **stay**

let someone **go first**

let someone **try**

let someone **decide**

Real talk. Mesma estrutura de MAKE, sem “to”, mas sentido oposto: um força, o outro permite. “Let her go” e “make her go” mudam a história inteira.

COMPLETE THE ONE THAT FITS YOUR LIFE

My boss lets us ___ from home on Fridays. _____

On weekends, I let myself ___ until midnight. _____

Our neighbors let us ___ their pool whenever we want. _____

05

ALLOW SOMEONE TO DO

ALLOW + person + TO + VERB

Permission, but official. A rule, a policy, an institution decides.

FORCE

PERMISSION

Oakwood C.I. has a sign for everything. One rule says no. Right next to it, a glass box says yes, quietly, on its own terms.



1 doesn't allow students to use phones

The school doesn't allow students to use their phones during exams.

2 allows students to make private calls

The phone pod allows students to make private calls between classes.

3 allow her to leave early

The coordinator allows her to leave early on Fridays for her internship.

BORROW THESE

allow someone to **enter**

allow someone to **bring**

not allow someone to **use**

allow someone to **submit late**

allow someone to **reschedule**

Real talk. ALLOW é o LET de terno: mesma permissão, mas com “to” e peso institucional. “My mom lets me” é natural. “My mom allows me to” soa quase um contrato.

COMPLETE THE ONE THAT FITS YOUR LIFE

Company policy allows employees to ___ two days a week from home. _____

The gym doesn't allow members to ___ after 10 pm. _____

My contract allows me to ___ once a year. _____



BONUS CASE: ONE SHOP, FIVE VERBS

Loja de Brinquedos Alegria, Saturday morning. Choose the verb that fits each scene.



1. The line at the cashier is long. Nobody skips it. (*makes / lets / gets / allows*)
2. His dad ___ him to see how cool the box looked. (*made / got / let / allowed*)
3. The LEGO table is free to use for anyone. (*makes / lets / gets / allows*)
4. Trying on hats before buying ___ her excited. (*makes / lets / gets / allows*)
5. Store policy ___ children to test any toy before paying. (*makes / lets / gets / allows*)

SAME IDEA, FIVE GRAMMARS

STRUCTURE	PATTERN	WHO DECIDES	FEEL
Make + adj	make + person + adjective	the situation, not a person	causes a feeling
Make + do	make + person + base verb	the one with authority	no choice, obligation
Get + to do	get + person + to + verb	shared, through persuasion	convinced, not forced
Let + do	let + person + base verb	the one who allows	informal permission
Allow + to do	allow + person + to + verb	a rule or institution	formal permission

QUICK CHECK

- The dentist always ___ me nervous, even before he says a word.
☐ lets ☐ makes ☐ gets
- It took the whole meeting, but she finally ___ the team to accept the new schedule.
☐ made ☐ allowed ☐ got
- Airport rules don't ___ passengers to carry liquids over 100ml.
☐ allow ☐ let ☐ get
- My grandma always ___ us stay up late during the holidays.
☐ allows ☐ gets ☐ lets
- The smell of fresh bread from the kitchen ___ everyone hungry.
☐ makes ☐ gets ☐ allows

SECTION 02

Practice Lab

Judgment first, then transformation. Five scenarios to argue with, then the mechanics: upgrade, negate, question, and the plot twist.

BLOCO A · WHAT WOULD YOU DO?

No right answer. Read the situation, choose a side, then say why.

SCENARIO 01

Your employee arrives 40 minutes late, saying the car had a flat tire. It's the third time this month.

Would you ☐ let it go or would you ☐ make him explain in writing ?

WHY?

SCENARIO 02

A colleague refuses to use the new project management tool. She says it's a waste of time, but the rest of the team already switched.

Would you ☐ get her to try it for a week or would you ☐ make her use it starting today ?

WHY?

SCENARIO 03

Your company is deciding on a hybrid work policy. Some managers want everyone back in the office five days a week.

Would you ☐ allow employees to choose their own schedule or would you ☐ make everyone come in the same days ?

WHY?

SCENARIO 04

Your 16-year-old wants to go to a concert on a school night with friends you've never met.

Would you ☐ let her go or would you ☐ only allow it if a parent you know goes too ?

WHY?

SCENARIO 05

A client is unhappy about a delay and is threatening to cancel the contract.

Would you ☐ get them to agree to a partial refund or would you
☐ allow them to cancel with no penalty ?

WHY?

BLOCO B · PURE PRACTICE

B1 · UPGRADE THE SENTENCE

The traffic made him angry. → The traffic made him _____

The news made her sad. → The news made her _____

The final exam made them scared. → The final exam made them _____

The presentation made him tired. → The presentation made him _____

The gift made her surprised. → The gift made her _____

B2 · MAKE IT NEGATIVE

Rainy days make me sad. → _____

The school makes students wear uniforms. → _____

She got him to apologize. → _____

My parents let me stay out late. → _____

The airline allows pets in the cabin. → _____

B3 · TURN IT INTO A QUESTION

Rainy days make me sad. → _____

The school makes students wear uniforms. → _____

She got him to apologize. → _____

Your parents let you stay out late. → _____

The airline allows pets in the cabin. → _____

B4 · THE PLOT TWIST

Negating these verbs doesn't just soften them. Some flip to the opposite end of the spectrum entirely.

MAKE, NEGATED

AFFIRMATIVE **My boss makes me work weekends.**



FORCE PERMISSION

NEGATED **My boss doesn't make me work weekends.**



FORCE PERMISSION

Removing the obligation doesn't feel neutral, it feels like relief. Negated MAKE slides all the way toward permission territory.

LET, NEGATED

AFFIRMATIVE **She lets her kids stay up late.**



FORCE PERMISSION

NEGATED **She doesn't let her kids stay up late.**



FORCE PERMISSION

This isn't weak permission, it's a rule. "Doesn't let" means prohibits. The dot doesn't slide, it jumps to the other end.

ALLOW, NEGATED

AFFIRMATIVE **The airline allows pets in the cabin.**



FORCE PERMISSION

NEGATED **The airline doesn't allow pets in the cabin.**



FORCE PERMISSION

Same jump as LET, only with a policy behind it. "Doesn't allow" is a formal ban, not a soft no.

GET, NEGATED (THE EXCEPTION)

AFFIRMATIVE **I got him to apologize.**



FORCE

PERMISSION

NEGATED

**I didn't get him to
apologize.**



FORCE

PERMISSION

No flip here. It just means the persuasion failed. GET stays in the middle, negated or not, because it was never about power in the first place.

B5 • MIXED REVIEW

1. "My landlord ___ raise the rent without 60 days' notice." Which fits a legal restriction?
☐ gets to ☐ isn't allowed to ☐ makes
2. "___ your parents let you travel alone when you were a teenager?"
☐ Do ☐ Did ☐ Does
3. "I get nervous before every presentation." What does this GET mean here?
☐ persuade ☐ become ☐ obtain
4. "The dentist's office ___ let me reschedule twice this month." Which negative fits a policy that ran out of patience?
☐ won't ☐ doesn't get to ☐ isn't making
5. "It took three meetings, but we finally ___ the board to approve the budget."
☐ let ☐ allowed ☐ got
6. "___ the new policy allow remote employees to expense their internet bill?"
☐ Does ☐ Is ☐ Did

SECTION 03

Reading Lab

Two Ways to Raise a Kid. An editorial reading using the same five structures, with comprehension, grammar spotting, and discussion.

TWO WAYS TO RAISE A KID



Modern parenting rarely looks like a full-time job. It looks like this.

At the playground on Saturday morning, you can spot the difference in seconds. One group of parents sits on a bench, phones down, eyes locked on every wobble^① of the slide. The other group is by the coffee cart, barely glancing over when a kid disappears behind the climbing frame.

Psychologists have a name for the first group: **helicopter parents**. They hover^②. They **make** their children wear helmets on tricycles, wash their hands every twenty minutes, and finish every worksheet before dinner. They don't **let** a six-year-old walk to the corner store^③ alone, and they rarely **allow** a birthday party to happen without a parent standing quietly by the cake table.

The second group has a name too: free-range parents^④. They **let** their kids climb higher than most adults are comfortable watching. They **allow** eight-year-olds to walk home from school with a set of house keys and a phone. Nobody **makes** these children ask permission to get a snack; the pantry is just there, at kid height, for a reason.

Neither philosophy is new. What changed is the fear behind it. A generation ago, parents worried about traffic and strangers, real but statistically rare^⑤ dangers. Today, many parents worry about something harder to name: the idea that any unsupervised moment might cause lasting harm, socially, academically, emotionally. Watching a child climb too high still **makes** most parents nervous, whichever camp they belong to. Nobody wants to be the one adult at the party who let something happen.

Free-range advocates argue the opposite fear is just as real. If a child is never **allowed** to fail on their own terms, the theory goes, they arrive at adulthood without ever having solved a real problem alone. A parent who solves every conflict for their kid isn't protecting them, they're just delaying the first real conflict a few years, to a moment when the stakes⁶ are higher and the parent isn't in the room.

The difference often shows up in small negotiations, not big rules. A free-range parent might spend ten minutes **getting** a reluctant⁷ four-year-old to put on his own shoes, through bargaining⁸, humor, a countdown, anything but force. A helicopter parent, running late⁹ for the same reason, is more likely to just **make** him sit down and put them on herself.

Most parents, if you ask them directly, don't fully belong to either camp. They **let** their toddler fall off the low step, but they'd never **let** a ten-year-old take the subway alone. They **make** their teenager text when they arrive somewhere, but **allow** her to choose her own friends without interrogation¹⁰. The line moves, case by case, kid by kid, city by city.

What both camps agree on, oddly, is the goal: a kid who can be trusted to make good decisions once no one is around to make them anymore. They just can't agree on how much rope¹¹ gets a child there, and how much rope gets a child hurt.



Whatever the philosophy, the instinct to hold on tight starts early.

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- 1. **wobble**, balanço, instabilidade
 - 2. **hover**, pairar, ficar rondando por perto
 - 3. **corner store**, mercadinho da esquina
 - 4. **free-range parents**, criação com mais liberdade e menos supervisão
 - 5. **statistically rare**, estatisticamente raro
 - 6. **the stakes**, o que está em jogo, o risco envolvido
 - 7. **reluctant**, relutante, resistente
 - 8. **bargaining**, negociação, barganha
 - 9. **running late**, atrasado(a), sem tempo a perder
 - 10. **interrogation**, interrogatório, terceiro grau
 - 11. **rope**, “corda”, aqui: quanta liberdade/autonomia dar

COMPREHENSION CHECK

1. True or False: free-range parents let their children walk home from school alone.

2. According to the text, what changed between generations, if not the parenting philosophy itself? _____
3. True or False: the text says free-range parents never negotiate with their kids.

4. According to free-range advocates, what happens if a child is never allowed to fail?

5. True or False: most parents belong completely to one camp or the other.

6. What is the one goal both camps agree on? _____

GRAMMAR SPOTTING

Each quote uses one of the five structures from Quem Manda Aqui. Which case number does it belong to?

"They make their children wear helmets on tricycles." → _____

"They don't let a six-year-old walk to the corner store alone." → _____

"They allow eight-year-olds to walk home from school with a set of house keys." → _____

"Watching a child climb too high still makes most parents nervous." → _____

"A free-range parent might spend ten minutes getting a reluctant four-year-old to put on his own shoes." → _____

"They let their toddler fall off the low step." → _____

DISCUSSION

Would you let an 8-year-old walk to school alone in your neighborhood? Why or why not?

Would you rather raise a confident risk-taker or a cautious rule-follower? Can you have both?

Which line from the text do you agree with the most, and which do you disagree with?

APPENDIX

Answer Key

For the teacher, or for checking your own work after class.

BONUS CASE (LOJA DE BRINQUEDOS)

1. makes — Obligation, no choice, no “to”.
2. got — Gentle persuasion, with “to”.
3. lets — Informal permission, no “to”.
4. makes — A feeling, followed by an adjective.
5. allows — A written rule, formal, with “to”.

QUICK CHECK (LESSON)

1. makes
2. got
3. allow
4. lets
5. makes

B1 · UPGRADE THE SENTENCE

The traffic made him **absolutely furious**

The news made her **completely devastated**

The final exam made them **absolutely terrified**

The presentation made him **completely exhausted**

The gift made her **utterly astonished**

B2 · NEGATIVE

Rainy days don't make me sad.

The school doesn't make students wear uniforms.

She didn't get him to apologize.

My parents don't let me stay out late.

The airline doesn't allow pets in the cabin.

B3 · QUESTION

Do rainy days make you sad?

Does the school make students wear uniforms?

Did she get him to apologize?

Do your parents let you stay out late?

Does the airline allow pets in the cabin?

B5 · MIXED REVIEW

1. isn't allowed to
2. Did
3. become
4. won't
5. got

6. Does

READING · COMPREHENSION CHECK

1. True.
2. The fear behind it, what parents are afraid of.
3. False. The shoes example shows the opposite.
4. They arrive at adulthood without ever having solved a real problem alone.
5. False. Most parents mix both, depending on the situation.
6. Raising a kid who can be trusted to make good decisions alone.

READING · GRAMMAR SPOTTING

"They make their children wear helmets on tricycles." **Case 02, MAKE + person + base verb.**

"They don't let a six-year-old walk to the corner store alone." **Case 04, LET + person + base verb (negated).**

"They allow eight-year-olds to walk home from school with a set of house keys." **Case 05, ALLOW + person + to + verb.**

"Watching a child climb too high still makes most parents nervous." **Case 01, MAKE + person + adjective.**

"A free-range parent might spend ten minutes getting a reluctant four-year-old to put on his own shoes." **Case 03, GET + person + to + verb.**

"They let their toddler fall off the low step." **Case 04, LET + person + base verb.**